



USHERS TRAINING & BRIEFING

LYNTONE EVENTS · TRAINING SERIES

2026

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Welcome To The Team!

An usher is often the first human connection a guest has with the event. Your presence, preparation and attitude set the tone for everything that follows.

By the end of this training you will know how to receive and guide guests, communicate with courtesy, manage seating and crowds, handle protocol and VIPs, work as one team and stay calm when plans change.

Remember: "Your attitude is part of the event experience."

"One team. One standard. One experience."



Table Of Contents

- Welcome To The Team
- Training Objective
- Who Is An Usher?
- Key Responsibilities
- The 5-Second Welcome
- Professional Communication

- Dress Code & Presentation
- Seating & Guest Management
- VIP & Protocol
- Difficult Guests — CALM
- Crowd & Emergency Response
- Teamwork & Final Briefing
- The Usher's Pledge



Training Objective

This handbook prepares every usher for confident, professional service. By the end of the training, every usher should understand:

- Your roles and responsibilities
- Communication & etiquette
- Protocol & VIP handling
- Handling difficult situations
- Receiving & guiding guests
- Seating & crowd management
- Teamwork & coordination
- Dress code & conduct

Great ushers do more than point at chairs. They create order, warmth and confidence from the moment a guest arrives until the final debrief closes the day.

"Your attitude is part of the event experience."



Who Is An Usher?

An usher is the first point of contact between the event and the guest — the welcome people remember long after the day is over.

An usher should be:

- Welcoming
- Alert
- Professional
- Helpful
- Respectful
- Approachable



The Usher

Great ushers read the room. They notice confusion, congestion and special needs early — then they act, or they report.

Calm eyes, warm words, clear directions:

"See the person. Read the moment."



Responsibilities — Before

- Arrive early
- Understand the venue layout
- Know washrooms and key facilities
- Identify VIP / protocol areas
- Know where to direct each category of guests
- Attend the team briefing
- Know entrances and exits
- Check seating arrangements
- Confirm emergency procedures

"Preparation is the first service of the day."



Responsibilities — During

While the event runs, you are the visible, moving calm of the venue.

- Welcome guests warmly
- Assist with seating
- Help elderly guests, persons with disabilities and families
- Identify and report issues early
- Give clear directions
- Manage movement around the venue
- Maintain order without being aggressive
- Work with the coordinator and security team



After The Event



**Guest Care ·
Close Well**

Service continues until the final debrief. Every usher should:

- Assist guests as they exit
- Help with orderly movement out of the venue
- Report and hand in lost property or incidents
- Check your station one last time
- Participate in the final team debrief



The 5-Second Welcome

Every guest should feel acknowledged — quickly, naturally and respectfully.

SMILE



MAKE EYE CONTACT



GREET



OFFER ASSISTANCE

"Good morning, welcome — how may I assist you?"

Avoid pointing from a distance. Walk the guest, or give clear directions.



Professional Communication



Sound Like This

Words that build confidence:

- Please
- Thank you
- Welcome
- Excuse me
- Kindly
- "May I assist you?"



Never Like This

"I don't know."

Say: "Let me confirm that for you."

"That's not my job."

Say: "Let me connect you with the right person."

*No arguing · no shouting
no slang · no negativity.*



Dress Code & Presentation

Ushers should appear smart, clean and coordinated at all times.

- ✓ Clean and neat outfit
- ✓ Appropriate, comfortable shoes
- ✓ Well-groomed hair
- ✓ Minimal accessories
- ✓ Fresh breath and good hygiene
- ✓ Name tag or identification where provided
- ✓ Phone kept away while on duty

"You are part of the event's image."



Seating & Guest Management

Every usher should know:

- General seating areas
 - Reserved / VIP seating
 - Family or special seating
 - Staff areas
 - Restricted areas
 - Emergency exits
-

When directing guests:

- Face the direction of travel
- Give calm, clear instructions
- Walk the guest whenever possible
- Keep pathways open and unblocked
- Never give conflicting instructions — confirm first

"Kindly proceed this way — I will show you your seating area."



VIP & Protocol

VIP guests are handled discreetly and respectfully — protocol should feel effortless.

KNOW

Confirm designated VIP areas and the approved arrival route before guests arrive.

COORDINATE

Work with the protocol officer. Avoid crowding VIPs, unnecessary attention or announcements.

THE LINE

Never independently change protocol arrangements — act only when authorised.



Handling Difficult Guests

The goal is not to win an argument — it is to protect dignity, safety and the guest experience.



CONTROL

your emotions



ACKNOWLEDGE

the concern



LISTEN

carefully



MOVE IT

to the appropriate person

Never argue, insult, threaten or physically confront a guest — and never escalate an argument.

*"I understand your concern —
let me get the event coordinator to assist you."*



Crowd Management

Ushers support safe, smooth movement. Ushers are not security officers.

YOUR ROLE

- Guide guest movement
- Prevent unnecessary congestion
- Keep entrances and pathways clear
- Direct guests consistently
- Alert security early

THE LINE

Do not physically confront a guest or attempt security interventions. Notify security immediately — give the exact location and a brief description.



Emergency Response



Know before you need to know:

- Emergency exits
- Assembly point
- First-aid location
- Security personnel
- Event coordinator
- Communication channel

In an emergency:

1. Stay calm
2. Alert the responsible team
3. Guide the guests
4. Avoid panic
5. Follow the emergency plan



Teamwork & Communication

Ushers work as one team. Radio and phone communication should always be:



"There is something happening over there, maybe you should come."

Instead, say:

"Coordinator, assistance required at the main entrance."



What Ushers Should Not Do

The actions you avoid are as important as the actions you take.

- ✗ Leave your post without informing the team leader
- ✗ Use your phone unnecessarily
- ✗ Eat while attending to guests
- ✗ Sit in guest areas while on duty
- ✗ Take photos with guests without permission
- ✗ Argue with guests
- ✗ Share confidential event information
- ✗ Drink alcohol while on duty
- ✗ Give unauthorised instructions
- ✗ Abandon your station

"Protect the standard — protect the experience."



Practical Training Activities

Keep the session hands-on. Run short simulations, rotate roles and debrief what worked — and what should change.

01

THE WELCOME

Greeting, eye contact, directions, assistance.

02

DIFFICULT GUEST

Listen, stay calm, resolve or escalate.

03

VIP ARRIVAL

Coordinate discreetly with protocol.

04

LOST GUEST

Clarify the need, then guide professionally.

05

ENTRY CONGESTION

Communicate, open the flow, escalate risk early.

"Practice the moment before it happens."



Final Team Briefing

No usher takes a station without clear answers to these essentials:

WHO

is the team leader?

WHERE

are you stationed?

WHAT

is your specific responsibility?

WHEN

do you report?

WHO

do you report to?

HOW

will the team communicate?

WHAT

should you do in an emergency?

THE GOLDEN RULE

SEE IT → ASSESS IT → ASSIST OR REPORT IT



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The Usher's Pledge



"I will represent the event with professionalism, respect and integrity. I will welcome guests warmly, communicate clearly, work as part of a team, follow instructions and remain calm under pressure. I understand that every guest interaction contributes to the overall event experience."

NAME & SIGNATURE

DATE

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Let's Make It Happen

Lynton Events trains and deploys professional event teams across Kenya — from ushers and coordination to full event experiences.



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